Facilitator Script — First Session with a Participant

For whoever sits with a participant the first time they use Gap Sense. Follow it in order so every participant gets the same introduction. About 25 minutes.

Participants may be blind, low-vision, or DeafBlind. Say everything out loud. Do not point. Put the phone in their hand and guide their fingers when asked.

Before they arrive (5 min)

- ❑ Gap Sense installed on their phone, or on a loaner phone.
- ❑ In Accessibility: **Vibrate on cue** on. For a DeafBlind participant, set output to **Visual only, with no sound** and rely on vibration.
- ❑ Volume at about two-thirds. Silent switch position does not matter.
- ❑ Phone screen locks set to **Never** for the session, so the app does not go dark mid-exercise.
- ❑ The participant's crossing times entered in Instructor setup (or their instructor's link opened), or example times loaded for a first session.
- ❑ The first-run notice ("Before you start") already read with the participant and **I understand** pressed, or read it together in step 1.
- ❑ This script, and the participant's consent form if your study uses one.

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1. Welcome (2 min)

Say:

> "This app helps you learn how long your own street crossing takes. Not in seconds. As a feeling in your body. It will never tell you a number. It plays sounds and vibrations instead. It is meant to be used with your O&M Specialist, and it does not replace their teaching. There are no right or wrong answers today. We are only interested in what you notice."

2. Learn the three signals (3 min)

Open **Accessibility**, press **Test haptic pulse**. Say, as each plays:

> “One knock. That is your own tap played back.” “Three knocks. That means you were close enough.” “One long buzz. That means you were too far off.”

Play it twice more. Ask:

> “Can you tell the three apart by touch alone?”

Record the answer: yes / no / partly. If no, try the phone in a different grip or against the wrist, and note what helped.

For hearing participants, also open **Help**, then **Run the sound tutorial**, and repeat with sounds.

3. Where the times come from (1 min)

Say:

> “The app already knows how long your crossing takes. Your instructor timed it and set it. Today you will learn to feel that length of time.”

If no real times exist yet, use **Try it now with example times** and say that these are examples.

4. Part 1, Practice my timing (6 min)

Sit down. Say:

> “Press the button. Imagine stepping off. Wait as long as you think your crossing takes. Press again. Then listen to the space between the sounds.”

Let them do at least eight attempts. After the fourth, ask:

> “Are you counting, or feeling?”

If counting, say:

> “Try to stop counting. Think of the walk instead. The feeling is the point.”

Note roughly how many attempts until the three-knock signal becomes common.

4b. Part 2, Comparison preparation (4 min)

Say:

> “This time the app starts the clock. Press Ready. The app says ‘Get ready’. Then wait. A steady sound starts, like hearing a car. Press when you think you would finish crossing. The sound stops.”

Four to six rounds. The waits vary on purpose. If they press early, say: “That was before the sound. Nothing is saved. Press Ready again.” Note whether the feeling holds without the rhythm of two taps.

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5. Part 3, Comparison practice (5 min)

Say:

> “You will hear a sample warning time: one steady sound. Decide if it is longer than your crossing, about the same, or shorter. The whole screen becomes an answer pad: swipe up for longer, down for shorter, tap for about the same. Or press a

> button. You hear right away if you were right. Then listen: the sample plays again, and your own sound marks where your crossing time ends. The space between them is the difference."

Press **Play a sample warning time** for each round. Six to ten rounds. Note anything they say out loud about how they decide, and whether they use the buttons or the swipe pad.

Then say: "Longer does not mean long enough. Your instructor teaches how to judge that."

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6. Wrap-up questions (3 min)

Ask and write down the answers in their own words:

1. "Which signal was easiest to feel? Which was hardest?"
2. "Did anything in the app confuse you?"
3. "Would you use this on your own, at home? Why or why not?"
4. "Is there anything you wish it did?"

Thank them. Remind them the app is theirs to keep practicing with.

Common problems

What happens	What to do
No vibration	Accessibility, check **Vibrate on cue** is on. On iPhone, confirm it is the installed app, not Safari.
No sound	Volume buttons. The silent switch does not mute the app. Accessibility, **Play a test sound** says whether sound is running.
Buttons locked	Crossing times are not set. Enter them in Instructor setup, open the instructor's link, or load example times.
An activity is missing on Home	The instructor turned it off in Instructor setup.
App will not open after some weeks	TestFlight build expired. Tap the invite link again, press Install.
Screen reader talks over the sounds	Normal. The app quietens the screen reader during playback on purpose.

What to send back to the research team

For each participant, in one message or spreadsheet row:

- date, participant code, phone type
- three-signals-by-touch: yes / no / partly, plus what helped
- attempts until "within margin" became common in Part 1, and whether it held in Part 2
- the four wrap-up answers, verbatim where possible
- anything that broke, with the exact words on screen